

Comprehension and inference

Paper 1 · Question 1 · 20 marks | syllabus 2027-2029

What you will learn

Locate exact evidence, infer attitudes, paraphrase meaning and explain a writer's effect.

How this assessment works

All candidates take Paper 1. Centres then enter candidates for Paper 2 or the Coursework Portfolio. Speaking and Listening is optional and separately endorsed. The supplied June 2026 papers inform presentation only; question structure and word limits in this guide follow the 2027-2029 syllabus.

Explicit meaning and selective evidence

A retrieval answer reports what the text actually says. Underline the key words in the question, find the matching passage and give only the number of distinct points requested. If the task asks for two details, two versions of the same detail earn no extra credit.

Worked example

Question: Why was the new vehicle difficult for unplanned appointments? Answer: It had to be booked a day in advance, so residents could not arrange a journey for an unexpected appointment.

Inference, own words and writer's effect

An inference adds a conclusion supported by details, not an invented event. For "in your own words", replace the meaning of the whole phrase. For effect, name a specific word or image, explain its associations and show why it shapes the reader's view.

Worked example

The worn timetable suggests Mira carries it frequently and has been trying repeatedly to explain the bus issue. The physical detail makes her concern feel persistent and personal.

Practice paper

Comprehension and inference

All passages and questions in this FagusED practice are original. Write in English. Marks appear in square brackets. Use the lines provided; extra paper may be attached if required.

Name: _____

Date: _____

Quick check · FagusED diagnostic (outside the Cambridge paper)

A brief study check; the official 0500 written papers use structured and extended answers.

Which statement is directly stated?

- A The bus was replaced every day
- B The booking service required a day's notice
- C The council cancelled all transport
- D Mira owned a car

Reading text

The last morning bus used to cross the valley at 6.40, carrying three students, a nurse and whoever had parcels to collect in town. When it was withdrawn, the transport office announced that very few passengers would be affected. Its figures were correct on an average day; they did not show what happened to the five regular passengers.

For Mira, the nurse, the change meant a forty-minute walk to a road served by another route. In summer she could make the journey. In winter the footpath became slippery before dawn, so she borrowed a car from a neighbour. The three students began leaving home at six and waiting outside the bakery for a lift from a parent who worked nights. One missed an early examination when the parent's car failed to start.

The transport office offered a telephone booking service for a smaller vehicle. Calls had to be made a day ahead, and the vehicle could not carry large parcels. Residents welcomed the idea in principle, but several said it was difficult to predict the day on which a hospital appointment or a delivery would be arranged. Others liked the quieter road and felt that an almost empty bus had been expensive to run.

At the council meeting, Mira placed a paper timetable on the table. Its corners were worn from weeks in her coat pocket. "The numbers tell you how many people were on the bus," she said, "but they do not tell you how much depended on it." The chair agreed to review both the booking rules and the early journey.

Questions

1(a) At what time did the last morning bus cross the valley? [1]

1(b) Give two reasons the early bus mattered to the students. [2]

1(c) Explain in your own words why the office's average figures were incomplete. **[2]**

1(d) What does the worn timetable suggest about Mira? Support your inference with a detail. **[3]**

1(e) Explain the effect of the phrase "the numbers ... do not tell you how much depended on it". **[4]**

1(f) Identify two different concerns about the replacement booking service. **[2]**

1(g) Evaluate one advantage and one disadvantage of the council's proposed review, using details from the text. **[6]**

Answers and teacher guidance

Check your response only after finishing the practice. Responses can be expressed in other valid words when their meanings are supported by the source.

1(a) 6.40 [1].

1(b) The bus brought them to town for school [1]; without it they had to wait for a parent's lift / one missed an early examination when the car failed [1].

1(c) The figures counted passengers on a typical journey, but overlooked how important the service was to the small group who relied on it [2].

1(d) It has worn corners because she kept it in her coat pocket for weeks [1]; this suggests sustained concern and preparation to make her case [2].

1(e) "Numbers" represent a narrow, impersonal measure, set against the wider effect on daily life. The contrast makes the official statistic seem inadequate and encourages readers to consider individual consequences [4].

1(f) Booking required advance notice [1]; the smaller vehicle could not carry large parcels [1].

1(g) A review might make short-notice travel more usable and restore early access for students and workers [up to 3]; it may still be costly to run a lightly used route, and those who welcomed quieter roads could object [up to 3]. Credit reasoned evaluation anchored to the text.

Diagnostic answer

1: B

Source for assessment structure: Cambridge IGCSE First Language English 0500 syllabus for 2027–2029, <https://www.cambridgeinternational.org/Images/718783-2027-2029-syllabus.pdf>. Original passages and questions by FagusED; June 2026 papers and mark schemes supplied by the user consulted for response layout and feedback style. This is independent study material, not an official Cambridge paper.